DRAFT : Outline Vision Statement, for discussion purposes

Working Title : “Our (primary) school is at the Museum...”

1.0. Content:

In this school, life follows all the norms of best practice primary education and the regular core curriculum.

But... every subject or topic would, at some point in the school year, be founded in or related to an object, or selection of objects, from the museum collection. For example, using the core curriculum subjects: *(note: alphabetical illustration by an architect not a teacher!)*

- *Access Issues:*
  Are there any friends and colleagues who cannot physically join in with all of our lessons and activities in school and in the museum spaces without some extra support? How can we make it comfortable and fun for them too, so that we’re all able to share our experiences in this school, equally?

- *Art & Design*
  Can we draw, paint, print, sculpt, photograph.... the objects?
  How does the object look in different colour, light material? Was it designed? Can we design a range inspired by the object? Maybe to sell in the museum shop?...

- *Citizenship*
  Did children associated with the objects in the collection have the same rights as we now have? Did their mothers and fathers or sisters and brothers? How did everyone help each other at that time? How do we do that now? How is our school organised in the place that we live? How will it be, when my children come to primary school?

- *Design & Technology*
  What were the available contemporary technologies? What was the function of the object? How do we deal with that function today?How does one design such an object in 2012; how will we in 2050?

- *English / Foreign Language*
  “every object has a story”; there will be innumerable opportunities to look at contemporary writings as well as inspiration for creative writing. Where do the objects come from?... maybe other lands; other languages?...

- *Geography*
  Where do all the objects come from? What culture do they represent? What is that country or other area of the country like: the people? the topography? the nature? the production of the object? If the object is from another part of the world, why is it here?

- *History*
  Where does this museum or collection sit in our cultural history locally, regionally, nationally, internationally? Who were the characters associated with the objects? What has been the effect of their lives on ours?

- *ICT*
  How does the museum record the collection? How does it relay information to children who don't go to school next door? How can the meaning of the collection be analysed? Can we get as close to our museum "virtually" to other museums all around the world?

- *Mathematics*
  Collections generate numbers, statistics, weights, geometries, proportions and more.....

- *Music*
  Are there any musical objects or sounds associated with the collection? Are there songs about the people or times explained in the museum? How does the museum sound? Can we give a concert using music and costumes from a period described by the collection?

- *Personal Social and Health Education*
  Does the collection represent a different historical time or place? If I lived then and there, how would I have been looked after? How would I have learned and developed? What did I eat? How did I rest and play? How will my children find these aspects of life in twenty years time, or so?

- *Physical Education*
  How can we keep healthy and fit in this school? Is it different from past children here? Why is it important for the future children? How can we organise indoor and outdoor games and sports to be fun for us all?

- *Religious Education*
  How many religions or beliefs are represented by objects or people associated with the Collections? What are those beliefs? Do we hold them all today? What are the functions of those beliefs? Do we have current alternative ways of providing those functions?

- *Science*
  The science of materials; the physics of structures; the nature of specimens; the chemistry of the fabric or its geological extraction. Scientific attributes as well as the history of science will be there.

The objects, their stories and the children's close involvement with the collection will create a cultural weave; a rich and robust fabric that is unique to that school. Although every school has a common element of curriculum, each museum school will have unique qualities over and above that.

Cultural continuity, a strong sense of belonging and communal experience as local junior citizens with continuation of what has gone before and what is set to come in the future can be explored.
Social and material values can be relatively defined. The children would learn from objects and consider how will their conclusions differ from their grandparents', parents' and children's thoughts to come?

2.0. Accommodation and Operations

Primary Schools and Museums share many common functional requirements

- assembly place
  - for the school, this involves the whole school coming together as one body
  - for the museum, for group visits and events
- refreshments
  - the school needs lunch facilities
  - the museum needs public refreshments and catering for events
- toilets
- cloakrooms
- classrooms
  - typically a museum will have some classroom/seminar facilities. Clearly a school will need more....
- library/archive/information
- reception
- staff facilities
- FM Staff / workbase
- Security

There could be a good deal of overlap, savings and efficiencies in the costs-in-use budgets for such elements, that could be very reasonably set against relatively moderate capital costs in the remodelling/extension/conversion work required.